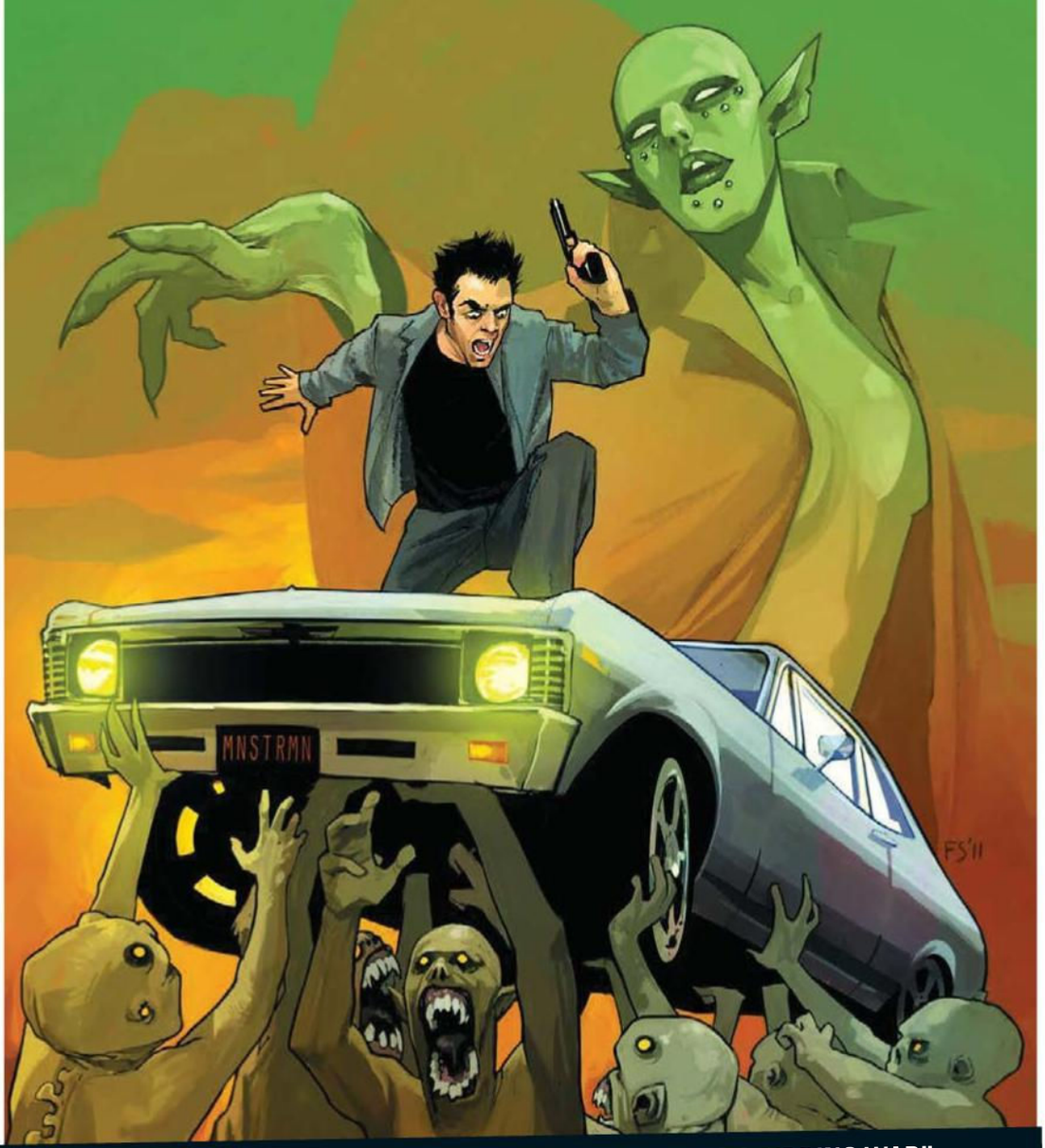


"WHEN WE WERE SELLING 30 DAYS OF NIGHT, IT TURNED INTO A BIDDING WAR" STEVE NILES

"I remember when I got the call about *Remains*, I could tell everybody was sort of apologetic, like, 'Do you want to do a TV movie?' but I was thrilled."

Remains is one of several projects being adapted from the writer's work. Next up may be a *Criminal Macabre* film starring Constantine-esque monster hunter Cal MacDonald, which is being developed by Universal. "After being through multiple studios, Universal really gets it," claims Niles, "and they're letting us do it as an R. For years, people wanted to do it as a PG-13, and I was like, 'Have you read the comic? There's really not a lot of PG-13 stuff!' I had breakfast with Mike Richardson from Dark Horse yesterday, and will hopefully have some good news in the next six months or so.

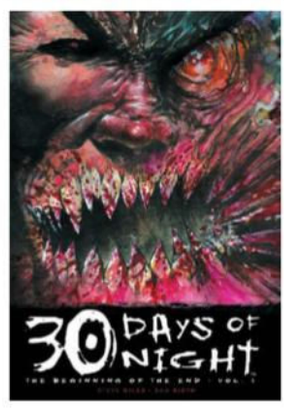
"I'm also continuing with the comics. I just turned in the latest instalment of *Criminal Macabre*, so we're keeping the comics going, and we're also going to reprint the novels. So yes, something will happen with Cal MacDonald. If it doesn't pan out as a horror movie, I think it would be a wonderful series. I've been writing him for 20 years now, so we could have many seasons if we had it on TV."

Just in case film/television adaptations aren't enough, Niles confirms that he's been approached about a possible stage version of one of his books. "I can't say which one, because I haven't actually met with them yet, so we still want to make sure it's possible, but what I can say is it's going to be one of mine and Bernie Wrightson's," he says, bringing up the influential artist who cut his teeth on classic chillers like *Swamp Thing*, *House Of Secrets* and *House Of Mystery* for DC Comics in the Seventies.



***30 Days Of Night* was adapted into a feature film by *Eclipse* director David Slade in 2007.**





Niles' work displays an inherent love for the medium.



***Criminal Macabre* could be the next Niles property to hit the big screen.**

"What we're trying to do is a live Bernie Wrightson comic. Bernie wants to paint the sets, so I'm going to have a problem there, because the backdrops are going to be original Bernie Wrightson art, so they're going to be more valuable than anything!"

As for future projects, Niles seems to have a remarkable knack for predicting what the next wave of horror will be. *30 Days Of Night*, as we observed earlier, pre-empted the vampire boom, while *Remains* foretold the current glut of zombie-mania. He's also re-teamed with Wrightson for IDW's *Frankenstein, Alive Alive,* which will see release before the flood of upcoming *Frankenstein* spin-offs.

"I'm a fan of this stuff," Niles reflects. "When we did *30 Days...*, it was for free, so Ben [Templesmith, artist] and I had an opportunity to do a different kind of vampire. I'm a huge horror fan. I don't think there's anything I haven't seen ten times, so I have that thing in me where I want to do my versions, but I do have a complete aversion to just doing what somebody did before. I always want to come up with some sort of fresh new take, but it really is coming out of the spirit of fun. For a horror writer, I use the word 'fun' a lot, but that's really what it comes from.

"With the *Frankenstein* book, I carried Bernie's first *Frankenstein* book around when I was a kid, and now I'm working with him on the sequel. It's just enthusiasm, because I genuinely love this stuff. I've never felt I've been predicting anything ahead of any curve, as that's a dangerous road to go down. I just do what I love, and I happen to love Frankenstein, vampires and zombies!"

Criminal Macabre is available from Dark Horse Comics, priced $2.99 (approx £1.90). A number of Niles' past titles, including *30 Days Of Night* and *Remains* are available digitally from Comixology.